

How Biden TikTok law became a Trump win

Statute forced the app’s sale, but new owners are likely to be MAGA allies

BY DREW HARWELL AND EVA DOU

When President Joe Biden signed a law last year forcing the sale of TikTok, top Democrats and China hawks heralded it as a triumph. Four years earlier, Donald Trump tried and failed during his first term in the White House to push through a similar measure, but the Biden administration worked aggressively with Congress to craft a law officials said would sever all risks of political influence from China, where TikTok’s owner, ByteDance, is based.

Now, some critics of an extraordinary deal to spin off a U.S. version of TikTok say that effort has backfired. The app’s recommendation algorithm will remain in ByteDance’s hands under the proposal, undermining one of the Biden team’s central justifications for the law. TikTok’s new owners are likely to include corporate interests tied to some of Trump’s most prominent backers, including Larry Ellison, Jeff Yass and Rupert Murdoch, who some fear could exert their own political influence. China even eked out its own kind of win in the process, hitching the company to broader negotiations with the United States regarding concessions on tariffs and trade.

The wildly popular video app will soon be spun off into a new U.S. joint venture mostly owned by American investors who “are

SEE TIKTOK ON A18

Justices allow firing of last FTC Democrat

High court will review Congress’s power to set up independent agencies

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL

The Supreme Court on Monday cleared the way for President Donald Trump to fire the sole remaining Democrat on the Federal Trade Commission, the latest victory in his aggressive push to exert greater control over the federal bureaucracy.

The justices overturned a lower-court injunction that reinstated Rebecca Slaughter to her position with the agency that oversees antitrust and consumer protection issues while litigation over her removal works its way through the courts.

“Congress gave independent regulators removal protections to preserve the integrity of our economy. Giving the executive branch unchecked power over who sits on these boards and commissions would have seismic implications for our economy that will harm ordinary Americans,” her attorneys said in a statement. “This stay is not a final ruling on the merits, and it will not deter us from defending Commissioner Slaughter’s lawfully held position at the Federal

SEE FTC ON A4



ANGELA WEISS/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

French President Emmanuel Macron addresses delegates at the United Nations in New York on Monday. “The time has come. ... I declare that today France recognizes the state of Palestine,” said Macron, who had spent months building up support for the initiative.

France defies Trump, recognizes state of Palestine

BY JOHN HUDSON

NEW YORK — France recognized a Palestinian state on Monday, overcoming a months-long push by the Trump administration to intimidate and discourage countries from working with Paris on the initiative.

Secretary of State Marco Rubio had tried to kill the initiative in the cradle, issuing cables to U.S. embassies and consulates around the world in June and this month to discourage attendance at France’s meetings and publicly slamming the effort as a “gift to Hamas.”

But on Monday, at the outset of

Rubio had sought to kill multicountry initiative at U.N. General Assembly

the United Nations General Assembly, French President Emmanuel Macron and his Saudi co-hosts assembled a large gathering of world leaders and top diplomats spanning Europe, the Middle East, Africa, Asia and Latin America. A speakers list included the presidents of Brazil, Turkey, South Africa and Indonesia; prime ministers of Australia, Can-

ada, Spain, Belgium and Ireland; kings of Jordan and Monaco; the U.N. secretary general; and many other dignitaries.

“The time has come,” Macron said, speaking in the cavernous U.N. General Assembly building. “I declare that today France recognizes the state of Palestine,” he said to a wave of applause.

Macron recruited key U.S. allies in the effort, including Britain, Canada, Australia and Portugal, which all recognized a Palestinian state on Sunday.

The effort is a morale boost to the Palestinians, but it will create no immediate changes on the ground, where Israel’s far-right

government has ruled out the creation of a Palestinian state. Israeli U.N. Ambassador Danny Danon called the event a “circus.”

White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt condemned the recognition effort, saying it “does not do anything to release the hostages, which is the primary goal right now in Gaza,” and “does nothing to end this conflict and bring this war to a close.”

“These decisions are just more talk and not enough action from some of our friends and allies,”

SEE PALESTINE ON A15

Israel: Netanyahu vows Palestinian state will never be established. **A15**



CAROLINE GUTMAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A sunken gravestone from the Cheltenham Youth Detention Center cemetery in Maryland.

A ‘secret cemetery’ comes to light

Effort begins to restore neglected Md. burial site of 230 Black boys

BY KATIE METTLER AND MICHAEL BRICE-SADDLER

The founder of Maryland’s legislative Black Caucus heard whispers of a “secret cemetery” holding children’s graves, so in 1972 he walked into the woods to see for himself.

Among weeds and crawling vines, then-state delegate Troy Brailey found cracked gravestones marking the burial plots of Black boys who died during the late 19th and early 20th centuries at a state juvenile detention facility with a document-

ed history of abuse and neglect. It was called the House of Reformation and Instruction for Colored Children.

Brailey, a prominent civil rights leader who has since died, called the site located 22 miles southwest of Washington, D.C., in Prince George’s County “disgraceful” in an Afro-American newspaper article about his visit. State officials later launched an inquiry.

Their conclusion: The boys had died of “consumption,” an old word for tuberculosis. Their

SEE GRAVES ON A6

Disney returns Kimmel late-night show to ABC

Program will be back Tuesday after suspension following Kirk’s killing

BY SCOTT NOVER AND JEREMY BARR

Jimmy Kimmel will return to television Tuesday, nearly one week after Disney-owned ABC took his long-running late-night talk show, “Jimmy Kimmel Live!” off the air under pressure from the Trump administration, station owners and conservative critics over comments he made after the killing of right-wing activist Charlie Kirk.

“Last Wednesday, we made the decision to suspend production on the show to avoid further inflaming a tense situation at an emotional moment for our country,” The Walt Disney Co. wrote in a statement Monday. “It is a decision we made because we felt some of the comments were ill-timed and thus insensitive. We have spent the last days having thoughtful conversations with Jimmy, and after those conversations, we reached the decision to return the show on Tuesday.”

Kimmel outraged some conservatives in his monologue Sept. 15 when he said “the MAGA gang” was trying to paint the accused killer, whom Utah Gov. Spencer

Trump links Tylenol, autism

NO FIRM EVIDENCE OF A CONNECTION

Claims about a potential therapy also raise alarms

BY ARIANA EUNJUNG CHA, MATT VISER AND DAN DIAMOND

The Trump administration on Monday ventured into uncertain scientific territory, calling to limit the use of one medication under investigation for a possible connection to autism while pushing to expand access to another being studied as a potential therapy — despite the lack of definitive evidence for either.

“Taking Tylenol is not good,” President Donald Trump said during a briefing at the White House. “I’ll say it. It’s not good.”

U.S. health officials warned that acetaminophen, the active ingredient in Tylenol and more than 600 other medications, should be avoided in early pregnancy except in cases of high fever — a sharp pivot in public health guidance on a medication that many major medical associations, including the American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists, say is safe. The administration said that the Food and Drug Administration would be updating the drug’s labeling and that a letter would be sent to all physicians in the country.

Trump also highlighted leucovorin — a drug used to treat the

SEE AUTISM ON A8

Leucovorin: Potential therapy has real — and fragile — promise. **A8**

Medical advice: What experts say about Tylenol and autism. **A17**



Jimmy Kimmel’s show was suspended after right-wing backlash to one of his monologue jokes.

Cox had said had a “leftist ideology,” as “anything other than one of them,” and suggested Trump was feigning grief over the killing to “score political points.” Kimmel had previously condemned the shooting and those who celebrated it. His jokes leading up to his suspension did not target Kirk but rather Republicans whom Kimmel accused of exploiting the death, including Trump’s son Eric (“This poor guy might need someone to adopt him,” Kimmel said), Vice President JD Vance (and “his little mascara-stained finger”), and FBI Director Kash Patel, who was heard repeatedly sniffing into a microphone in Kimmel’s clip montage.

The monologue was standard fare for Kimmel. And the right-wing backlash to it did not seem especially remarkable until Trump’s Federal Communications Commission chairman, Brendan Carr, appeared on a conservative podcast Wednesday and linked Kimmel to “a very concerted effort to try to lie to the American people

SEE KIMMEL ON A2

IN THE NEWS

Justice Department Intensifying demands from President Donald Trump have raised alarm among federal prosecutors. **A5**

Trump aide named as U.S. attorney Lindsey Halligan, a White House adviser with no experience as a prosecutor, will lead the office in the Eastern District of Virginia. **B14**

THE NATION New Mexico will soon offer free child care, regardless of income. **A2** **Charlie Kirk’s death** is forcing some Black Christians to reckon with his rhetoric and their faith’s values. **A3**

THE WORLD As Russia targets Ukraine’s energy installations, Kyiv is launching retaliatory strikes. **A9** **Egypt’s highest-profile** political prisoner, an Arab Spring activist, was pardoned. **A16**

THE ECONOMY Monthly bills for housing, health care and utilities are outpacing inflation and taking an outsize share of Americans’ paychecks. **A17** **A fireworks** display in the Himalayas put on by outdoor brand Arc’teryx has led to an environmental probe. **A18**

STYLE Kirk has left behind young followers all over Washington. **B1**

SPORTS Napheesa Collier, an MVP finalist and one of her sport’s most influential voices, is the perfect leader at the perfect time for the WNBA. **B8**

THE REGION A D.C. firefighter shot over the weekend said he gave up on 911 while waiting for a dispatcher and called his own fire station for help. **B14** **At high school** football games in D.C., some fans said new rules have made the events feel more peaceful. **B14**

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